DESIGN DOCUMENT · V1 · DERIVED FROM THE BRIEF ONLY

Zoomies

A training journal for calisthenics and rings. One person, one phone, offline. This document is the visual and interaction design: colour, type, spacing, components, the live session surface, and the rules that hold it together.

Phone only · iOS + Android   Light and dark   No imagery   No network

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01

The direction

The whole application is **one column of lines on paper**. There are no cards, no panels, no shadows, no containers with corners — only text, numbers, hairline rules, and generous vertical space. Hierarchy comes from size and from three levels of ink, never from decoration. The layout of every surface is the same layout: a small label, then lines. A notebook does not change its structure depending on what you write in it, and neither does this.

One accent — a dull clay orange — and it means exactly one thing: *this is happening now*. The current exercise in a live session, the running clock, the control that records the set. It appears nowhere else in the application. Because the accent is reserved, a live session is recognisable at arm's length from the floor without reading a word, and every other surface is monochrome and calm by construction.

Numbers are set in mono at tabular widths, and the numerals are the largest thing on any screen they appear on. That is the inversion the domain asks for: labels are small because you already know what a front lever is; the figure is huge because you are reading it at two metres with your pulse in your ears.

> DELIBERATELY NOT DOING
>
> No tab bar. No icon set beyond three marks. No cards or elevation. No filled buttons outside a live session. No animated numbers, ever. No summary screen that must be dismissed. No chart anywhere except one surface, where it is the point. No progress ring, no percentage, no gauge — a target is stated as a fraction of sets and left alone.

Two directions lost. A **dark-first instrument panel** (monospaced throughout, high-contrast readouts) read as a device rather than a record, and made the reflective surfaces feel like telemetry. A **large-tile grid** for mid-session tapping was faster to hit but forced every exercise into an identical box, which the mixed reps/seconds/note domain will not survive.

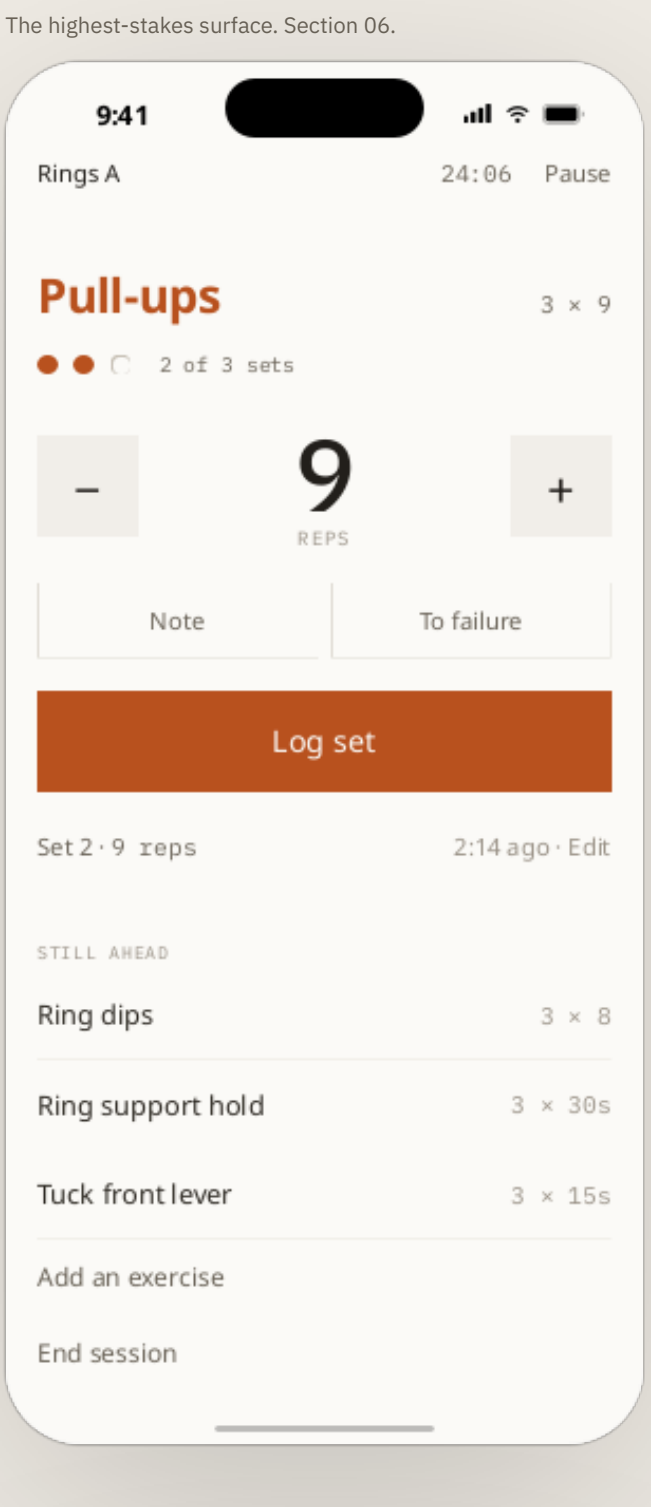
02

The surfaces

Five, flat. No nesting deeper than one push.

LIVE SESSION · COUNTED

The highest-stakes surface. Section 06.


9:41

Rings A   24:06   Pause

Pull-ups   3 × 9

● ● ○ 2 of 3 sets

−   9 REPS   +

Note   To failure

Log set

Set 2 · 9 reps   2:14 ago · Edit

STILL AHEAD

Ring dips   3 × 8

Ring support hold   3 × 30s

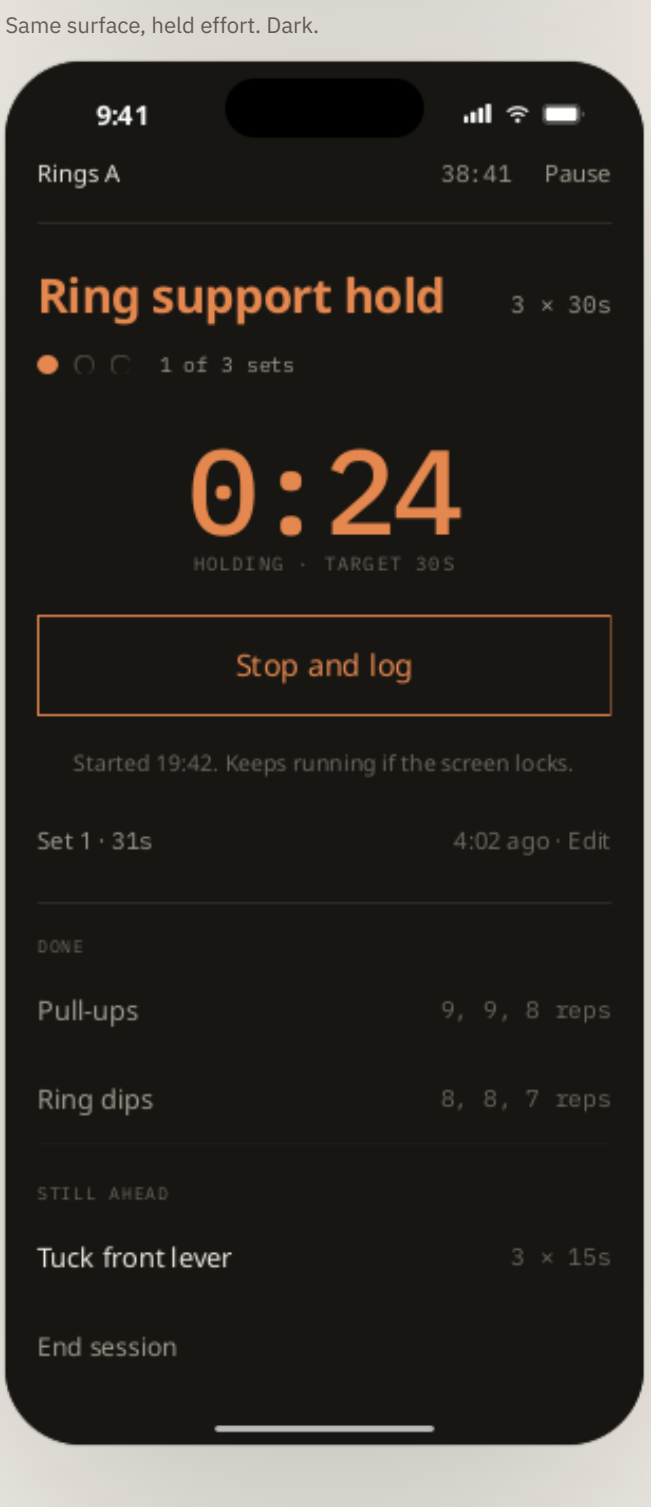
Tuck front lever   3 × 15s

Add an exercise

End session

LIVE SESSION · HOLD RUNNING

Same surface, held effort. Dark.


9:41

Rings A   38:41   Pause

Ring support hold   3 × 30s

● ○ ○ 1 of 3 sets

0:24

HOLDING · TARGET 30S

Stop and log

Started 19:42. Keeps running if the screen locks.

Set 1 · 31s   4:02 ago · Edit

DONE

Pull-ups   9, 9, 8 reps

Ring dips   8, 8, 7 reps

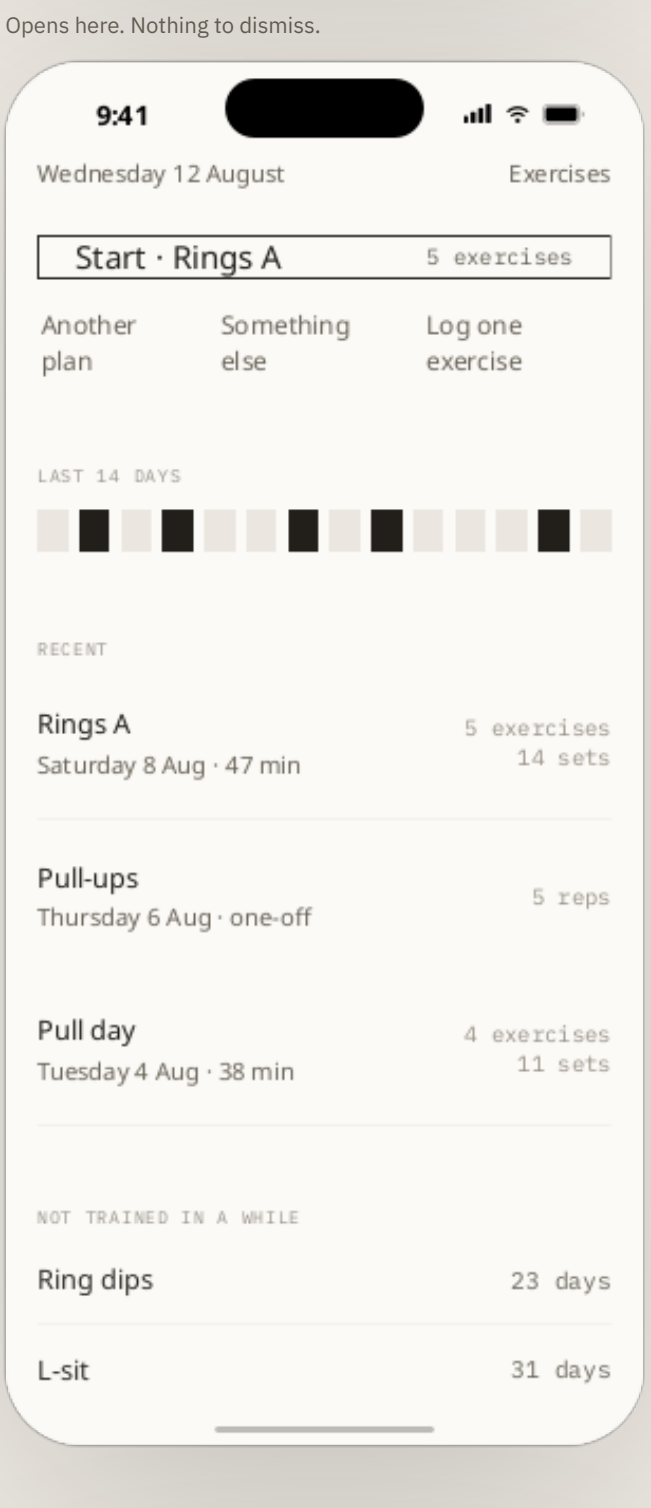
STILL AHEAD

Tuck front lever   3 × 15s

End session

JOURNAL · THE ONLY HOME

Opens here. Nothing to dismiss.


9:41

Wednesday 12 August   Exercises

Start · Rings A   5 exercises

Another plan   Something else   Log one exercise

LAST 14 DAYS

RECENT

Rings A   5 exercises 14 sets

Saturday 8 Aug · 47 min

Pull-ups   5 reps

Thursday 6 Aug · one-off

Pull day   4 exercises 11 sets

Tuesday 4 Aug · 38 min

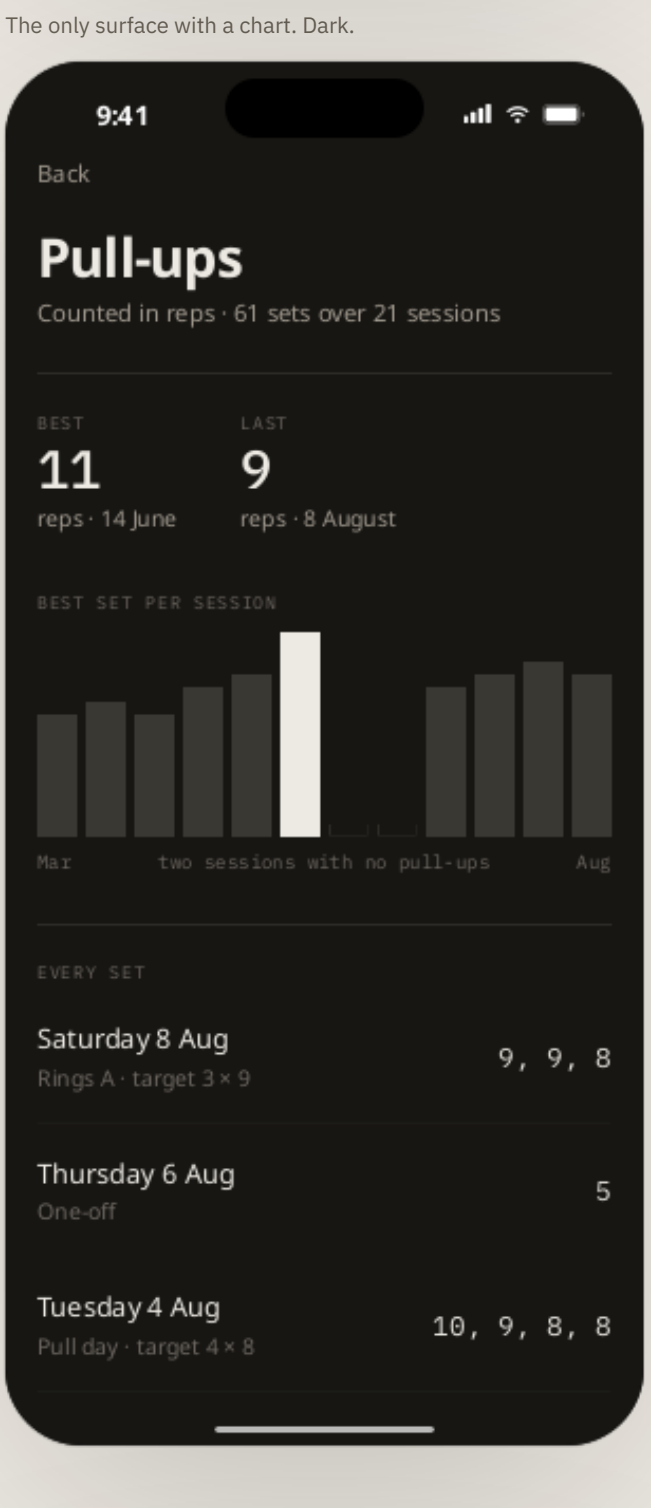
NOT TRAINED IN A WHILE

Ring dips   23 days

L-sit   31 days

ONE MOVEMENT · ALL TIME

The only surface with a chart. Dark.


9:41

Back

Pull-ups

Counted in reps · 61 sets over 21 sessions

BEST 11 reps · 14 June

LAST 9 reps · 8 August

BEST SET PER SESSION

EVERY SET

Saturday 8 Aug   9, 9, 8

Rings A · target 3 × 9

Thursday 6 Aug   5

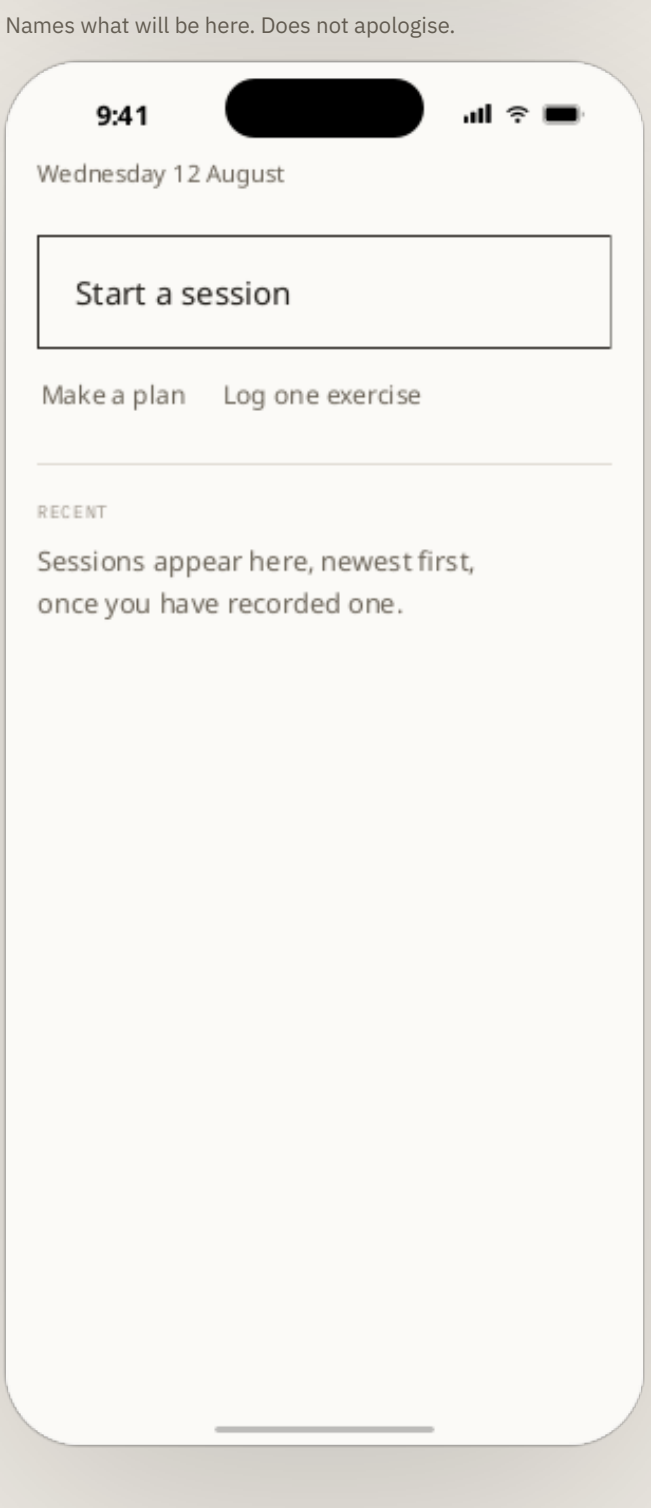
One-off

Tuesday 4 Aug   10, 9, 8, 8

Pull day · target 4 × 8

FIRST LAUNCH

Names what will be here. Does not apologise.


9:41

Wednesday 12 August

Start a session

Make a plan   Log one exercise

RECENT

Sessions appear here, newest first, once you have recorded one.

03

Colour

Twelve values, six per mode, one accent. Every value has a rule about where it may appear; if a use is not listed, it is not allowed.

	NAME	LIGHT	DARK	WHERE IT MAY APPEAR
■■	paper	oklch(98.2% .004 70) #FBFAF7	oklch(19% .006 60) #171613	Screen background. Nothing else has a background.
■■	sunk	oklch(95.2% .006 70) #F1EEE9	oklch(23.5% .006 60) #21201C	Stepper keys and the pressed state of any target. Never a card, never a container.
■■	rule	oklch(88.5% .008 70) #E0DCD4	oklch(29% .006 60) #2E2C27	1px section divider, and the border of an unfilled control. A lighter tint (#EBE7E0 / #232220) separates rows within a list.
■■	ink	oklch(24% .010 60) #221F1B	oklch(93% .005 70) #EDEAE3	Every recorded value, every row title, every heading. The default.
■■	ink-2	oklch(48% .010 60) #6B6459	oklch(70% .008 70) #A29B90	Dates, units, targets, secondary actions, anything that qualifies a value rather than being one.
■■	ink-3	oklch(64% .008 70) #9A9287	oklch(52% .006 60) #6E6862	Section labels, and **missing values only**. A dash in ink-3 means never recorded. No recorded number is ever this colour.
■■	now	oklch(53% .128 45) #B8511E	oklch(74% .120 55) #E5884F	Only inside a live session, and only on: the current exercise's name, its set pips, the running clock, and the log control. Four places. Nowhere else in the application.
■■	delete	oklch(46% .130 30) #9C3B26	oklch(72% .100 30) #E08A76	The word on a destructive confirmation. Never a filled surface, never an icon.

Why clay, and why so little of it. The accent had to be legible in direct sun and not glare in a dark garage, which rules out anything with high chroma at high lightness. It also had to not read as either a warning or a wellness brand, which rules out red and green. Clay at chroma .128 sits on the warm axis the paper already leans on, so it looks like ink on the same page rather than a UI element pasted on top.

Dark is the same design. Both modes use the same six roles, the same 24pt-of-lightness gap between ink and ink-2, and the same hue axis. Only the accent shifts lightness — the light-mode clay on a near-black paper is muddy and fails contrast on the log button.

Considered and rejected: no accent at all. It worked on every reflective surface and failed on exactly the one that matters — a live session needs to be identifiable in half a second from two metres away, and value contrast alone does not carry that far in poor light.

04

Typography

Two faces from one family, three weights, seven sizes. Both bundled with the binary — nothing is fetched.

> **IBM Plex Sans — words**
>
> Open apertures, unambiguous 1/l/I, and it holds up small and out of breath. Weights 400 and 500 only; 600 exists for the two 30px+ titles and nowhere else.

> `IBM Plex Mono — every number`
>
> All numerals, units, targets and section labels. Fixed advance width, so a running clock and an incrementing counter never move the layout — the brief's jitter constraint, solved by the face rather than by CSS.

SPECIMEN	SPEC	USED FOR
9	mono 500 · 64px / 1.0 tabular · −3% tracking	The value being entered, and a running hold clock (76px). One per screen, at most.
Pull-ups	sans 600 · 34px / 1.05	Surface title. Appears once, at the top, never repeated.
Ring support hold	sans 600 · 30px / 1.1	The current exercise in a live session. The only place this size is used.
Start · Rings A	sans 500 · 20px / 1.3	Bar-button label.
Ring dips	sans 500 · 17px / 1.35	Row title — the workhorse. 400 when the row is not a heading of anything.
Saturday 8 Aug · 47 min	sans 400 · 15px / 1.45	Everything secondary: dates, qualifiers, inline actions. Smallest sans permitted.
STILL AHEAD	mono 400 · 11px · +9% tracking uppercase · ink-3	Section label. The only uppercase in the application, and never tappable.

Why three weights are enough. Emphasis is carried by size and by ink level, which survive being read badly. A fourth weight would only ever be used to distinguish two things that a size step already distinguishes. Italic is not used at all — Plex's italic is lovely and would be decoration here.

05

Spacing & layout

STEP	WHAT IT SEPARATES
4	A value from its unit. Two lines that are one thought.
8	Adjacent controls in one group. Set pips.
12	Stepper keys from the figure between them.
20	Screen side margin. Fixed on every surface, every phone width.
24	Blocks within a section. Label to first row: 20 above, 4 below.
32	Between sections, above the rule that divides them.
48	Only to push the destructive action away from everything else.

Seven steps, 4-based, but not a doubling scale: the mid-range needs 20 and 24 as distinct values because 20 is the page edge and 24 is a block gap, and collapsing them makes rows look like they touch the frame. Nothing uses 16 — it landed between the two and made the rhythm ambiguous.

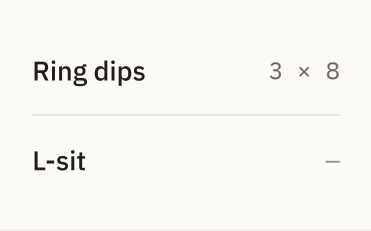
Reachability. Every surface puts its one primary control in the bottom third. In a live session the log control's top edge sits no lower than 300px from the bottom of the screen, and everything below it is either a value you just wrote or a list you are not required to touch. Destructive and navigational actions go to the top, where a chalky thumb will not find them by accident.

Targets. 56px minimum for a list row, 64px for anything tapped while tired, 72px for a bar button. Stepper keys are 64×64. Adjacent tappable rows are separated by a hairline and nothing else, so the target is the full row width — there is no small hit area anywhere in the application.

06

Components

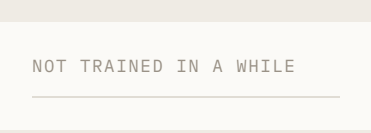
Nine. Adding a tenth should require an argument.


Ring dips   3 × 8

L-sit   —

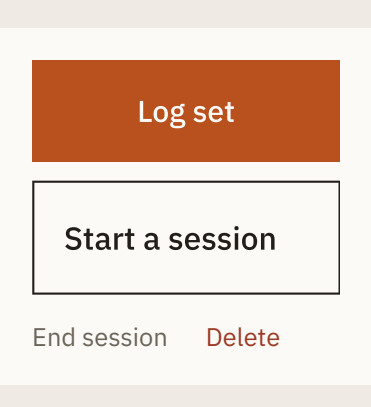
Row

Title left in sans, value right in mono. 56px min, full-width tap target, hairline below, no hairline above the first or below the last. A missing value is an em dash in ink-3 — never 0. No chevrons: if a row pushes, it pushes.


NOT TRAINED IN A WHILE

Section

A rule, 32px of space, an 11px mono label, then rows. Sections never collapse, never scroll horizontally, and never carry a count in their label — the rows are right there.

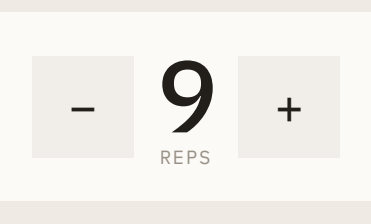

Log set

Start a session

End session   Delete

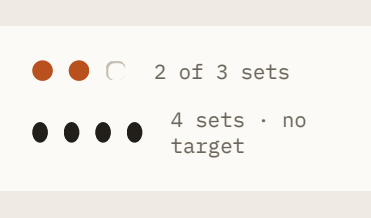
Button, in three strengths

Filled exists only inside a live session, only in the accent, only for logging — one per screen. **Outlined** (1.5px ink, 72px) is the primary action anywhere else. **Plain text** in ink-2 for everything remaining. No radius anywhere: squared edges read as ruled paper, and rounding was the single change that most made it look like a wellness app.


−   9 REPS   +

Stepper

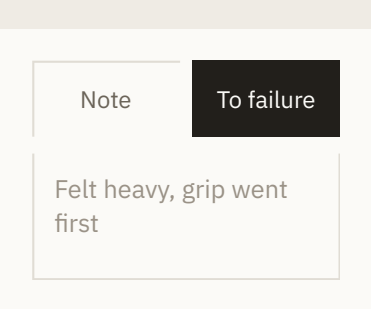
The only numeric input. Arrives pre-filled with the target, or with the last set's value once one exists. Two 64px keys, ±1, hold to repeat at 4/second. Tapping the figure opens the keypad for a large correction. No slider, no wheel, no free-typed field by default — all three need precision the hands do not have.


● ● ○ 2 of 3 sets

● ● ● ● 4 sets · no target

Pips

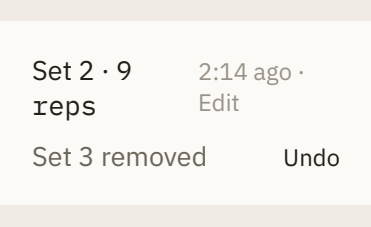
13px dots, 8px apart: filled for done, hairline outline for remaining, always with the count spelled out in mono beside them. This answers "how many sets have I done" pre-attentively, which the brief names as a constant question. Without a target, pips accumulate and there is nothing to be short of. Above nine pips, drop to the numeral alone.


Note   To failure

Felt heavy, grip went first

Mark & field

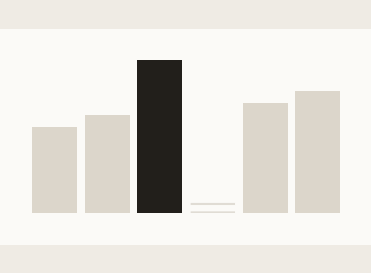
A mark is a 48px toggle, inverted when on — no icon, no colour, because "to failure" is a fact, not an alarm. A field is a hairline box with a 16px placeholder that states what goes in it. Fields commit on every keystroke; there is no Save.


Set 2 · 9 reps   2:14 ago · Edit

Set 3 removed   Undo

Last line & undo

The set just recorded stays visible directly under the control that recorded it, with its age, so the "was that my second or third" question is answered without navigating. Removing anything writes immediately and leaves an inline undo in place for 8 seconds. There are no confirmation dialogs except for deleting a whole session.



Column chart

Exists on one surface: a single movement over its life. One series, one unit, never a combined total. Best-ever is the one bar in full ink. A session where the movement was not trained is a 6px hairline stub, not a zero-height gap and not a bar of height zero — absence must be visible as absence. No axes, no gridlines, no tooltip.

07

The live session

Where the application either works or does not.

One scrolling column, always in the same four zones from top to bottom: **where you are** (plan name, elapsed, pause), **what you are doing now** (name, target, pips, the value, the log control, the set you just wrote), **what is left**, and **the way out**. The zone that matters occupies the middle of the screen and needs no scrolling on the smallest supported phone. The order never changes, because a layout you can predict is a layout you do not have to read.

Advancing	Logging the last targeted set of an exercise moves "now" to the next one automatically, and the finished exercise drops into a Done section above. No confirmation, no transition to acknowledge. You can also tap any row in Still ahead to jump — the plan is an order, not a rail.
Past the target	A fourth set of three is allowed and normal: a fourth filled pip appears and the count reads `4 of 3 sets`. Nothing turns green, nothing congratulates, nothing warns.
Held efforts	The stepper is replaced by a clock at 76px and the log control reads Stop and log. The clock is derived from a stored start timestamp, not a tick counter, so locking the screen or being force-quit changes nothing; on return it shows the true elapsed time. Under it, one factual line: the time it started.
Rest vs. pause	Rest is not modelled — it is the time between two sets and needs no interface. Pause is explicit, for when the session genuinely stopped, and it freezes the elapsed clock and replaces the now-zone with one line: `Paused 6 min` and Resume. Nothing counts down at you either way.
Abandonment	There is no session state held in memory that is not already on disk. Reopening after four minutes or after a kill restores the same scroll position and the same pre-filled value. The application never asks whether you want to resume — of course you do; it is simply still there.
Ending	End session is at the bottom, in ink-2, and it ends the session. What follows is the session's own page — the same read-only layout history uses — with a note field at the top. It is a page, not a summary that must be dismissed; leaving it is going Back.

Rejected: a full-screen one-exercise-at-a-time carousel. It made the value larger and the log target enormous, but it hid "what is left in this session" behind a swipe, and that is one of the two questions being asked constantly.

08

Recording a set

The interaction that happens hundreds of times. Taps counted from picking the phone up.

You hit the target, or repeat the last set. The value is already there. Tap the log control.	1
One short. Minus, then log.	2
Three short, taken to failure. Minus ×3, the failure mark, log. Both marks are on the surface, not behind a menu, because they are chosen while breathing hard.	5
A hold. Stop and log — the clock was already running from the tap that started it.	2
With a note. Note, type, log. The keyboard is the only modal moment in a live session and it is opt-in.	2+
Fixing the one you just logged. Edit on the last line opens it in place under the stepper. Adjust, then Done. The write happens on each adjustment, so leaving mid-fix is safe.	3
Adding something unplanned. Add an exercise, pick from your own movements — recent first, search below. It becomes the current exercise with no target.	2

What confirmation looks like. The pip fills, the count increments, the new set appears on the last line, and the value resets to the target. No toast, no checkmark, no sound, no haptic beyond the platform's standard tap. The record changing *is* the confirmation, and it is visible without moving your eyes.

Rejected: a swipe to log. One gesture, zero taps, and unusable — the brief is explicit that a confident swipe in a specific direction fails exactly when it matters, and there is no way to make an accidental one obviously reversible at a glance.

09

Empty states

Each one names what will eventually be there, in 15px ink-2, and stops. No illustration, no button unless the surface's primary action is already absent.

Journal, first launch	Start a session. Under Recent: "Sessions appear here, newest first, once you have recorded one."
No plans yet	"You have no saved plans. A plan is a list of exercises you can start with one tap." Then Make a plan. This is the one empty state that explains, because a plan is the one concept the interface invents.
Last 14 days, nothing in them	Fourteen empty marks, shown. The section is not hidden, because a fortnight with no training is information.
A month with no sessions	The month heading, then "Nothing recorded." It keeps its place in the list at full height. It is not skipped and not compressed.
A movement never trained	"Not trained yet." No best, no last, no chart, no zeros. The Every set section is absent rather than empty.
Trained once	Best and Last show the same figure, both stated plainly. The chart appears at one bar — a single bar is honest, and the surface does not wait for enough data to look good.
Not trained in a while	Absent entirely until at least one movement has a gap and there is history to measure a gap against. Never shows every movement you own.
Session with no sets	"No sets recorded." It stays in history as a session that happened and produced nothing, which is a true thing about that day.
Ad-hoc session, first exercise	Still ahead is absent, not an empty heading. Add an exercise sits where it would have been.

10

Motion

Four movements exist. Each is there because its absence would make a change hard to notice or a position hard to keep track of. Nothing animates to be pleasant.

WHAT	DURATION	WHY
Pip fills	90ms linear	Instant is indistinguishable from a redraw. 90ms is enough to catch peripherally without being a flourish.
Exercise advances	160ms ease-out	The finished block moves up into Done and the next takes its place. Without it, the whole screen appears to have been replaced.
Push / pop	platform default	Native on each platform, unmodified. Direction of travel is the only thing it needs to convey.
Undo line	120ms in · 8s · 200ms out	Long enough to notice and act on while tired; it fades rather than vanishing so a glance back reads as expiry, not loss.

Nothing else. In particular: numbers never count up, the clock never pulses, records never reveal, and no list ever staggers its rows in. A figure that animates cannot be read while it is animating, and reading it is the entire point. All motion respects reduce-motion by becoming instant, which costs nothing here because none of it carries meaning on its own.

11

Rules

For whoever works on this next, including the person who wrote it.

01 The accent means *now*. If it appears outside a live session, it is a bug.

02 Never show `0` for something that was not recorded. Missing is an em dash in ink-3, and the two states must be distinguishable without reading the label.

03 Never add reps to seconds. Every figure is either per-exercise in one unit, or a count of sessions, sets or days. No score, no index, no volume.

04 The write commits before the interface moves. No spinner, no optimistic state, no Save button anywhere in the application.

05 History shows the target that was in force that day. Editing a plan never changes a word of what a past session says.

06 A one-off is not a session. It appears in the journal and in a movement's history; it is never included in a session count.

07 A personal record is stated once, as a fact, in the same weight as everything around it. No badge, no colour, no exclamation, no reveal.

08 Absence is rendered, not hidden. Empty months, empty days and untrained movements keep their place at full height.

09 No consecutive-day count, ever — not in a label, not in a tooltip, not derived on the fly. Which days had training is a fact; a streak is a threat.

10 Nothing below 15px in sans or 11px in mono, and nothing tappable under 56px tall. A layout that needs smaller type is the wrong layout.

11 No gesture is the only way to do anything. Swipe may exist as a shortcut; it may never be the sole path.

12 Copy is second person, present tense, no imperatives that are not buttons, no exclamation marks, no praise, no apology. `Not trained yet`, not `No data available`.

13 When there is nothing to say, add nothing. A surface with one figure on it is finished if that figure is the answer.

OPEN, AND DELIBERATELY LEFT SO

Two things this document does not settle. **Exercise management** — the catalogue, the per-movement unit configuration and the export — are plain settings surfaces built from Row, Section and Field, and they need no design beyond that; if they turn out to need more, that is worth knowing. And **whether Journal should show the last 14 days at all**: it is the one element on a reflective surface whose job is closest to motivation, and it survives here only because it answers "have I actually trained this month" faster than the list below it does. If it ever acquires a number, delete it.